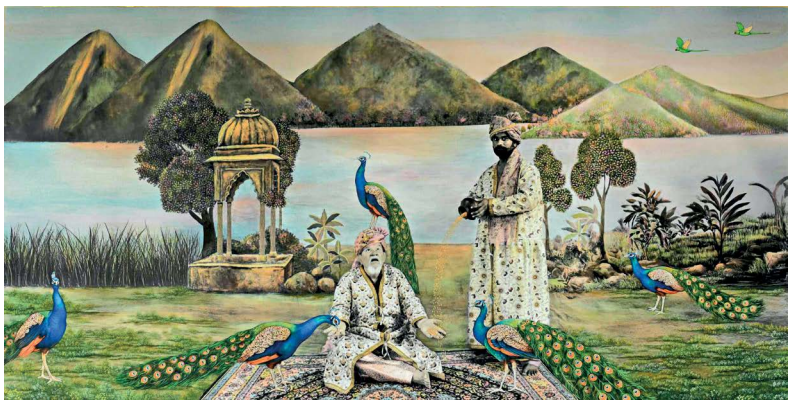


DETAILS THAT COUNT 'Long Short Stories #5', by Waswo and Dalpat Jingar

ART ▼

FINE AND DANDY

A NEW SHOW BY UDAIPUR-BASED AMERICAN ARTIST WASWO X. WASWO SEES HIM BLEND PHOTOGRAPHY AND RAJASTHANI MINIATURE PAINTING

When Latitude 28 moved to its new location in Delhi's Defence Colony a year ago, director and founder Bhavna Kakar was already in the process of putting together *Long Short Stories*, a solo exhibition by multidisciplinary artist Waswo X. Waswo, an American who adopted Udaipur as his home over 20 years ago. She says, "This is one of Waswo's most ambitious exhibitions in terms of scale, detail and the relationship between different mediums, bringing together photography, miniature painting, video and sculpture...creating a much more immersive experience."

We are encouraged to experience the exhibition as a journey through the chapters of a book. The longer one looks, the deeper one experiences the theatrical quality of Waswo's storytelling in the hand-painted digital prints embellished with gold leaf. Waswo usually works with a team of four traditional Rajasthani miniaturists whose skills dovetail with his vision. He points out how, in this show, Dalpat Jingar comes to the fore with his luscious painting and embellishments of photographs, whereas Chirag Kumawat shines with the work he has done on the François Balthazar Solvyns-style engravings.

> The exhibition is styled as a **narrative with the protagonist, The Dandy,** standing in for Waswo's life in Udaipur

While Waswo has dabbled with self-referential photography in the past, creating characters such as The Evil Orientalist, The Observer, and The Visitor to the Court, in the current iteration, The Dandy takes centre-stage. "This is somewhat a metaphor for my life in Udaipur, yet there are deeper sociological meanings. The narrative can actually be viewed as a bit of a romance," Waswo smiles.

"The Dandy is, in some ways, an extension of the artist. He is an outsider, an observer, occasionally a participant, and often someone who doesn't quite belong. There is humour and theatricality in the way Waswo presents him, but also vulnerability," Kakar observes. ■

—Priya Pathiyan

ART ▼

LAND MEETS LITERATURE

Sikkim's premier arts gathering is creating a space for intergenerational dialogue

Nestled in the cloudy lanes of Gangtok, the second edition of the Sikkim Arts and Literature Festival (SALF) is set to unfold. An initiative of Chief Minister Prem Singh Tamang (Golay), presented by the Students' Welfare Board (Education Department, Government of Sikkim) and produced by Teamwork Arts, the non-ticketed festival builds on the success of its inaugural edition in Yuksom.

ART ▼

Beyond the

Goa is a real place with real people

